Source:

ATHLETE, JPL, NASA: JPL Robotics: The ATHLETE Rover

Product Summary:

The ATHLETE is an All-Terrain-Hex_Limbed Extra-Terrestrial Explorer. It is a JPL robotic vehicle designed to move large cargo and equipment across the lunar surface. It has six articulated limbs where each has a wheel at the end. The ATHLETE can also lock its wheels and use the limbs as feet when the terrain gets difficult allowing it to move through different types of terrain.

Product Critique:

While it can navigate autonomously, humans still have to direct it. Examples of this direction include telling the vehicle to move a specific cargo panel, what objects to avoid, which direction to move towards, etc. Our vehicle, in comparison, must be able to move with no specific human input, if astronauts need to get cargo from the payloader that should be the only instruction the robotic vehicle receives. Essentially, the structural idea, especially the six limbs, of this robot is influential, however it lacks the degree of autonomy that our vehicle will need to exhibit.

Images/Sketches:



